

prevailing economic conditions. The NPS on the other hand is a mutual fund with guarantee of returns (might get higher returns as there's equity exposure).

[31] Some employers only deduct minimum amount required by EPF - 12% off 15,000 - and not the suggested 12% of your basic pay to decrease their match contributions. In that case, your equity portion will be huge within the portfolio. Don't worry yet - just try to invest as much as possible in a 60:40 proportion. You can consider adding more to EPF on your own (voluntary provident fund) to maintain this ratio.

[32] Use the C (Corporate bonds) and G (Government bonds) option and invest in equity elsewhere.

[33] The Sensex contains 30 of the largest stocks in terms of market capitalization. The returns closely mirror the Nifty which has 50 such stocks.

[34] In fact, studies have shown that trying to find lows via averaging aka timing the market results in higher absolute returns only 50% of the time. Thus in real time, investing in market lows has as much probability as winning a coin toss. See: <https://freefincal.com/possible-time-market/>

[35] One can use the "Freefincal Financial Freedom Calculator" at Google Play to generate the corpus required for any return and inflation assumption. An online version of this tool is also available at: <https://freefincal.com/tools/>

[36] Use the "Freefincal FU Money Calculator" at Google Play to check for your own numbers. An online version is also available here: <https://freefincal.com/tools/>

[37] Early retirement is a complex topic and all requirements for such a dramatic decision cannot be discussed here. You can consider reading more with the free e-book available at: <https://freefincal.com/e-book-retire-early-india/>